SEVEN-PHASE ENTERPRISE VALUE & GOVERNANCE

SEVEN-G: governing AI as a strategic asset

A free method to implement, govern and measure a company's AI, and to know with evidence whether it transforms or only becomes more efficient.



AI is a strategic asset →
It is not one more technology. Its decisions belong to the board, the chief executive and the chief financial officer, not to technology alone.

Two levels of governance →
The company decides in the corporate cycle (C1–C5). Each initiative goes through eight phases (0 to 7), with a decision gate at the end of each.

Stopping in time is a result →
Each gate requires results and verified evidence, and nobody approves their own work. The feasibility gate (G3) is the main stop gate.

Value the board can believe →
Full cost against efficiencies and return, case by case. Every figure carries its status and validated value is kept apart. «No data» is not zero.

Register, funnel and dashboard →
The initiative register (T01) runs the portfolio as a funnel and feeds the board dashboard (T17): cost, value, risk and what holds back scaling.

Free, open and connected →
CC BY 4.0 and no sign-up. SPHERES explains the nine spheres and the three ambition levels; SPAD, how software is built with AI.

Standards say what must exist; SEVEN-G is the operating layer that makes it work, initiative by initiative and portfolio by portfolio.

→ What SEVEN-G is · → Example board dashboard (Spanish) · → The core: fourteen rules · → SPAD: building software with AI

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Notes

SEVEN-G stands for Seven-phase Enterprise Value & Governance: a phase 0 that authorises the initiative, seven value phases and governance present in all of them. It is a complete method that lets a company, a consultancy or an independent professional implement, govern and measure AI, and answer with evidence a question that almost nobody can answer: is the company transforming with AI or only becoming more efficient? Both are legitimate. The problem starts when they are confused.

- AI is a strategic asset. It is not one more technology or one more product: it is an enabler, an accelerator and a transformer of the company. That is why its decisions belong to the board, the chief executive and the chief financial officer. The usual symptom is different: many pilots, few cases in production, value declared and never validated, and nobody who can stop a project. SEVEN-G starts from one premise: these problems are not about technology, they are about governance and measurement.
- Two levels of governance. In the corporate cycle, the board and senior management carry out the diagnosis (C1), set direction, ambition and risk appetite (C2), choose the portfolio (C3), oversee every quarter (C4) and review every year (C5). In the initiative lifecycle, each initiative goes through eight phases, from phase 0 (context and constraints) to phase 7 (evolution or retirement). The corporate cycle authorises and funds; each initiative returns evidence.
- Decision gates. At the end of each phase there is a gate. To pass it, results and verified documentation are needed at the same time: this is dual validation. The possible outcomes are proceed, proceed with conditions, iterate, pivot or stop. Whoever builds does not control, and nobody approves themselves. The feasibility gate (G3) is the main stop gate: it is always decided separately, before the big spend. Stopping for a reason is a valid result: avoiding a bad investment also creates value.
- Value the board can believe. Every amount has a formula and a status: validated by management control or audit, declared by the area, or estimated. Efficiencies, return and recurring cost are kept apart. Freed capacity does not count as savings until it materialises. «No data» is not zero.

- What you get. The initiative register (T01) manages the portfolio as a sales funnel: which stage each initiative is in, how long it has been there, what it costs, what is expected from it and, if it leaves, why. The same register feeds the board dashboard (T17). The figures in the site's example are fictitious.
- Free and connected. Documents, Word templates and tools are used at no cost and without sign-up, under CC BY 4.0 (content) and MIT (code), crediting Fernando García Varela. SPHERES is the explanatory layer of the impact map: nine spheres and three ambition levels (Optimise, Augment, Transform). SPAD governs how software is built with AI in the design and delivery phases; its verdicts do not replace any SEVEN-G gate.

What is non-negotiable fits in fourteen rules, the core (N-01 to N-14). Everything else is applied in proportion to risk: Express, Lite or Enterprise intensity per initiative. And compared with the standards: ISO/IEC 42001 or the EU AI Act say what must exist; SEVEN-G puts it to work with investment and value discipline.

Question for the classroom: think of a company you know. How many AI pilots does it have, how many are in production, and who could stop them today?

SOURCES AND LINKS

- **Document 00 · What SEVEN-G is and what it is for** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SEVEN-G/html/en/00_SEVEN-G_Que_es_y_para_que_sirve.html
- **Document 01 · Phases and gates (section 6.1)** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SEVEN-G/html/en/01_SEVEN-G_Metodologia_fundacional.html#6-1-summary-of-phases-and-gates
- **Document 01 · The SEVEN-G core (section 14.1)** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SEVEN-G/html/en/01_SEVEN-G_Metodologia_fundacional.html#14-1-the-seven-g-core
- **Document 04 · Compared with the standards (section 5.1)** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SEVEN-G/html/en/04_SEVEN-G_Origenes_diferencias_y_por_que_es_abierto.html#5-1-compared-with-the-standards-seven-g-as-an-ai-operating-model
- **SPHERES · What it is and what it is for** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPHERES/html/en/00_SPHERES_Que_es_y_para_que_sirve.html
- **SPAD · What it is and what it is for** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/00_SPAD_Que_es_y_para_que_sirve.html
- **What SEVEN-G is** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SEVEN-G/html/en/entrada/index.html
- **Example board dashboard (Spanish)** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SEVEN-G/herramientas/T17_panel_consejo/ejemplo/salida/t01_Dashboard_Casos_Uso_IA_v8.html
- **The core: fourteen rules** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SEVEN-G/html/en/01_SEVEN-G_Metodologia_fundacional.html#14-1-the-seven-g-core
- **SPAD: building software with AI** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/00_SPAD_Que_es_y_para_que_sirve.html

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